THEMES	Represented In Participants	DEFINITION
Landmark Coordination	P1, P2, P3, P5, P6, P8	Groups agree to meet at a fixed, easy-to-spot place (like a tree, bar, or stage) if they get separated.
Loose Group Coupling	P1, P2, P5, P6, P7	Friend groups split up to see different artists, then meet back up later.
Network and Phone Unreliability	P1, P2, P4, P5, P6, P7, P8	Phones often lose signal at festivals, so calls and texts don't work when you need them most.
Physical Coordination Tactics	P1, P2, P4, P5, P7	People use physical tricks, like shoulder rides, totems, or human chains, to find or signal friends in the crowd.
Ephemeral Stranger Connection	P1, P2, P3, P6, P8	Short, easy interactions with strangers (dancing, a compliment) that are fun in the moment but rarely continue after.
Personal Space & Approach Comfort	P2, P3, P4, P5, P8	People have mixed feelings about strangers approaching them, some like it, some don't, depending on how it happens.
Stranger interaction	P5, P7, P8	People like the idea of a fun, low-pressure way to start talking to strangers, especially if they're shy.
Shared atmosphere	P1, P3, P4, P6	The vibe of the crowd, lights, and music together matters just as much as talking to people.
Interactive Installation Precedent	P6	Some people have already tried fun physical installations at festivals and loved them.
Downtime / Between-Set Activity	P5, P8	People want something quick to do in the short gaps between artists.
Crowd Positioning & Findability	P3, P4, P6	Where you stand (front, back, sides) is a trade-off between a better view and being easy to find.
Safety & Physical Discomfort	P1, P3, P4, P7, P8	Worries about crowd crush, dehydration, long waits, and wanting somewhere safe to rest.

Participant 1		
Quote	**Additional Context**	**Theme**
I'm a bit of a solo, solo go once I get in there sometimes, especially if there's like a clash and I'm like really keen on who I want to see, I don't mind going off by myself	Explaining what happens when the group's stage preferences clash	Loose Group Coupling
at the very least, you usually do find your mates at the end of the festival or like out just outside, like usually you can get home together or like a few smaller groups, find each other, and yeah, everyone gets home safe	Describing how sub-groups reconverge by the end of the night	Loose Group Coupling
mostly people coming up to me because I have like colourful hair and I stand out like a, like a sore thumb at the festivals and everyone loves it	Describing how strangers usually initiate contact with him	Ephemeral Stranger Connection
it is hard to find people sometimes... if someone knows that you're being looked for, it's a good way, a good strategy to like put someone on your shoulders and like be a landmark so that your mates can see you from like the outside	Explaining what he does when the group loses each other in the crowd	Physical Coordination Tactics
we'll say, okay, like, we'll meet at said landmark... a big a big tree or like a certain type of bar or a merch stand	Describing how the group plans to split up or meet during the day	Landmark Coordination
Yeah, all the time it fails all the time. Like you don't go to a music festival expecting to have service quite honestly. You know that it's going to be real shit	Answering whether phone/network has ever failed him at a festival	Network and Phone Unreliability
some of the police presence isn't like too like nice... I like feeling safe, not feeling like supervised and like, yeah, watched over, like, by, yeah, a higher power. I'm trying to have fun	Describing the most frustrating part of the festival experience	Safety & Physical Discomfort
I really like sitting down after a music festival is probably like top 3 experiences ever	Listing his priorities when attending a festival	Safety & Physical Discomfort

Participant 2		
Quote	**Additional Context**	**Theme**
my group had a total of like 12 people... initially we had to find them first	Arriving late to the festival split across multiple Ubers	Loose Group Coupling
we were just sitting at the bench... it was under a tree actually... if people went to the bathroom they would also... look for the tree	Explaining how the group of 12 regrouped between sets	Landmark Coordination
if it's, like, complete strangers, it's pretty rare... although sometimes there would be, like, a stranger coming up to us and dancing with us, and I guess that's how we would connect... normally I don't think I would go to a stranger myself, because at music festivals they're normally in groups already, so it'll be a little weird to go into another person's group	Discussing whether she connects with strangers at festivals	Ephemeral Stranger Connection
I had to text them, and they just messaged... took a picture of their location. I had to roughly guess where they were... I had to go to random groups and pretend that I was in that group to join their train	Describing getting separated from her group at Ultra due to overcrowding	Physical Coordination Tactics
my friends got onto the, like, each other's shoulders so I can see them	Describing how she finally spotted her group in the crowd	Physical Coordination Tactics
I guess like having different stations, resting points... so we can find each other... there's more like checkpoints I guess	Suggesting what could improve the festival experience	Landmark Coordination

Participant 3		
Quote	**Additional Context**	**Theme**
we all ended up in the same area in a very packed venue... we have small circles	Describing unexpectedly running into old school friends and a teacher	Ephemeral Stranger Connection
No, I tend not to chat with strangers... 'cause usually they're busy with other people as well, and, like, I'm not really there to chat... I'm not really interested in making friends at a concert	Answering whether she chats with strangers at concerts	Personal Space & Approach Comfort
I don't think I've ever really split up from a friend. We don't really make plans, 'cause the venues that we're usually in are pretty small... we can usually find each other pretty much if you just stand there and wait	Explaining how she and her friend plan to meet up or split up	Landmark Coordination
I rather value my safety... in [Fortitude] Valley area where it's not necessarily safe for a young woman like me to be out at night... I make my decisions based on that as well	Explaining how safety factors into which events she chooses to attend	Safety & Physical Discomfort
Standing and waiting... having to make your way through a crowd is, can be annoying sometimes... there's a balance between how long you wanna wait and what kind of view you wanna get	Describing the most frustrating part of the concert experience	Safety & Physical Discomfort
I usually go for the balcony... I tend to like the balcony better 'cause you're above everyone else, and it can get crowded on the balcony, but I find it's less crowded	Describing where she likes to position herself at a venue	Crowd Positioning & Findability
People are quite nice and respectful... they would also make sure to leave enough space between me, my friend, and themselves. So people are generally really respectful at a concert	Describing interactions with strangers standing nearby	Personal Space & Approach Comfort
the most I could probably do with, like, stranger interaction is probably what Jacob Collier does with the conducting of the choir of the crowd, and then you feel like you're a part of... music... a part of a bigger thing... you work together to be part of a song	Reflecting on what stranger interaction she would actually be open to	Shared atmosphere

Participant 4		
Quote	**Additional Context**	**Theme**
I only ever go with one person to each music festival... we never lose each other... I guess we just stand next to each other all the time	Explaining how the group size stays constant throughout the festival	Loose Group Coupling
Often there's no signal, actually... calling, texting just doesn't work... normally I don't run into the problem of losing my friends. I just... we just find each other eventually somehow, 'cause usually we just stick close to each other	Describing what happens if she and her friend do get separated	Network and Phone Unreliability
we never, um, talk to other people... sometimes other people talk to us... they won't really, like, join us... I'm okay with it, but I don't like it. I don't like other people talking to me at music festivals. I'm there for my friend	Describing her attitude toward strangers approaching her group	Personal Space & Approach Comfort
a good performance is what makes things memorable... they had, like, torches on fire. They were, like, bashing barrels on stage. They were, like, spinning around	Describing what makes a performance stick in her memory	Shared atmosphere
a mosh pit just happened to open up where my friends and I were... people were, like, bashing us and stuff, and we got knocked to the ground... my phone died there permanently	Recounting getting caught in an unwanted mosh pit in the rain	Safety & Physical Discomfort
My priority is getting to the front... not damaging my hearing... Being at the front without losing my hearing... 'cause then you get to see the artist right in front of you	Listing her priorities when attending a festival	Crowd Positioning & Findability
I hate that I have to get there super early to have to be at the front... if you're inside the crowd, sometimes you have to pee, but you can't pee, 'cause if you go and pee, then you can't come back and get your spot back	Listing what she'd change about the festival experience	Safety & Physical Discomfort

Participant 5		
Quote	**Additional Context**	**Theme**
if there are different artists playing at the same time, the group splits up and whoever prefers each artist goes their separate way, then maybe meets up for a different one	Explaining what happens when the group's set preferences clash	Loose Group Coupling
I do have a buddy because we have the same taste and like the same things. If I didn't have her, I'd probably have to chop and change between buddies	Describing whether she has one consistent festival buddy	Loose Group Coupling
me and my friends made friends in the mosh pit and went on their shoulders — it was really cool	Recalling the most recent time she connected with a stranger	Ephemeral Stranger Connection
The one I remember most was a furry bean [totem]	Describing how her group of 40 found each other when split up	Physical Coordination Tactics
At BTV, yes, because there was no phone service. Where there is service it's usually texting, calling, or sharing locations — but with so many people the service is often pretty bad	Explaining how the totem-finding method compares to using a phone	Network and Phone Unreliability
I actually hate when people approach me, so I wouldn't enjoy that — but I love approaching people	Answering what would make her comfortable approaching/being approached	Personal Space & Approach Comfort
We talk about who wants to go where and make a plan, then set meeting spots and times throughout the day — either to just touch base, or to head to the next set together	Walking through how her group plans to meet up or split	Landmark Coordination
Having to find my friends who can't find their way around	Naming the most frustrating part of the festival experience	Landmark Coordination
Yeah, as long as they're not annoying	Answering whether she'd be open to talking to strangers between sets	Stranger interaction

Participant 6		
Quote	**Additional Context**	**Theme**
usually like you stick with your group, I feel, just to be safe and make sure everyone's accounting for. But at the bit like towards end the night, usually it splits off into like 2 or 3 little groups	Describing how the group's size changes over the course of the night	Loose Group Coupling
Either we like, make a meetup point, but that usually doesn't work. So we just try to call each other, but then that also usually doesn't work. So usually no one would ever leave without one other person	Explaining her current strategy for reuniting with separated friends	Network and Phone Unreliability
we met like so many people that I've never made so many friends in my life because everyone is just so happy... within 3 seconds we'd made a friend and we were dancing under their umbrella and like listening to music on their speakers	Recounting connecting with strangers at a Belgian festival	Ephemeral Stranger Connection
A compliment's a good word... something annoying is happening around and you can be like, oh, that's a bit annoying. And then they agree and then you start talking from there... bonding over a shared experience	Explaining what typically sparks a conversation with a stranger	Ephemeral Stranger Connection
it's also easier for your friends to find you as well if they like get lost or have read it or like if you want another group to join you	Explaining why she positions herself towards the edge of the crowd	Crowd Positioning & Findability
I took my shoes off and went into like the dust dome... people were like doing really interpretive dancing... everyone had the eye masks on... to feel the music and dance... someone was filming you and then once you took your mask off, you got to compare yourself to... how other people were dancing... it was cool because you got to like laugh about it	Describing an interactive sensory dome installation she experienced in Belgium	Interactive Installation Precedent

Participant 7		
Quote	**Additional Context**	**Theme**
you meet like random people there, and it's like it has this entire little subculture to it	Explaining what draws him to festivals over single-artist concerts	Ephemeral Stranger Connection
Yeah. 100%, yes. That's like half the fun... sometimes you go with like, you know, like 8 people, like you would just like leave with like 2 or something like that. There's casualties	Confirming that group size changes a lot through the event	Loose Group Coupling
if you go into like a smaller festival, then you'll usually like set up like a meeting point if like worst comes to worst. Otherwise, charge your phone... at a place like BTV... I'm planning on getting walkie-talkies because the cell service... tend[s] to cut out, but if you have your own walkie-talkie, it runs on its own network	Describing his strategy for relocating friends, and his plan for an upcoming 4-day festival	Network and Phone Unreliability
what made [the festival] good is... security guards... walking cups of water out to the front because they knew that the people that have been at the front of the mosh pit have been there for a really long time... you [get] dehydrated	Describing a positive crowd-welfare measure he noticed at a festival	Safety & Physical Discomfort
Transport to and from is easily the worst thing... I spent about... $150 in an Uber	Naming the most frustrating part of the festival experience	Safety & Physical Discomfort
Yes, I do it all the time [interactions with strangers]... Would you be open to, like, more games set up for you to interact with other people kind of thing? Like random games... That sounds cool... they had... a bunch of like [games]... It was really cool	Answering whether he'd be open to structured games/activities for meeting people between sets	Stranger interaction

Participant 8		
Quote	**Additional Context**	**Theme**
With my personality, I'm very to myself, so I don't usually interact with a stranger, but... we had these 2 girls behind us... they said 'oh my god, what are you excited to [hear]'... he got the conversation going	Recalling the most recent time she connected with a stranger, at the barricade waiting for Steve Lacy	Ephemeral Stranger Connection
I've wanted to like sort of reach... and say, 'hey, I think you're cool'... but I have such like a shy personality sometimes when it comes to that so I tend to not do it because I don't want to overstep boundaries or make people uncomfortable	Explaining why she usually doesn't approach strangers she finds interesting	Personal Space & Approach Comfort
If we had like developed a prototype of something... do you think you would use it?... Yeah, definitely. I think something that's almost like an icebreaker would definitely make me come out of my comfort zone as well	Responding to being asked if a prototype tool for connecting with strangers would help	Stranger interaction
we always come up with like a safe plan being like, if anyone's phone runs out of battery or the reception's really bad, just meet at this point after the set	Describing her group's backup plan for splitting up during a festival	Landmark Coordination
definitely not long. I don't think long activities would be possible because sometimes the break between certain artists that are only like on average 20 to 30 minutes... by the time you get to the activity... a lot of that time's already taken away	Explaining the time constraints on any activity offered between sets	Downtime / Between-Set Activity
when there ever there's downtime on my like list of artists that I want to see, I always appreciate sitting down, having a drink and eating food to just rest my legs a little bit	Describing what she typically does during gaps in her schedule	Downtime / Between-Set Activity
I think they've oversold... tickets and they'd found a venue that was too small to hold that amount of people... they didn't let us go see [an artist]... because they were at capacity	Describing what made her Laneway experience less enjoyable	Safety & Physical Discomfort